

Delaney M. Nolin M.S. (she/her)

Los Angeles, CA (willing to relocate)
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Marine Ecologist | Data Scientist | Project Manager

Marine environmental scientist and project manager with 6+ years of experience leading fisheries and marine ecosystem research, coordinating complex multi-stakeholder projects, and managing high-volume datasets. Skilled in QA/QC, compliance reporting, SOP development, and cross-functional coordination, with a strong record of supporting audits and ensuring procedural accuracy across long-term ecological monitoring programs. Adept at translating technical data into actionable insights to inform policy, certification, and sustainability initiatives. As a Team USA Paralympic athlete, I bring creativity, resilience, and an ability to recognize overlooked opportunities—qualities that allow me to solve problems strategically and thrive in fast-paced, collaborative environments.

Core Competencies and Technical Skills

- **Marine and Fisheries Science:** ecological field research, long-term environmental monitoring, climate modeling, water quality assessment, biodiversity assessments, microbial ecology, metagenomics, sustainability analysis, result synthesis for policy advice
- **Data & Analytics:** R, python, SQL, MATLAB, ArcGIS, database management, QA / QC, data compliance, GitHub / version control, bioinformatic pipeline engineering, data visualization
- **Project Management:** stakeholder engagement, grant writing, workflow optimization, cross-team coordination, novel project development, reporting and execution
- **Languages:** English (native) Spanish (proficient)

Research and Sustainability Professional Experience

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA, Los Angeles, CA

Marine and Environmental Biology Graduate Research Assistant

08/2016 – 01/2024

- Led multi-year research projects on marine ecological health in coastal California, requiring coordination of field sampling, high volume data analysis, data management, and cross-departmental collaboration.
- Managed data infrastructure and QA / QC protocols for research projects involving over 25+ researchers and external partners, ensuring accuracy and compliance across large datasets.
- Conducted water quality monitoring (nutrients, bacterial production, DNA/RNA extractions, flow cytometry, dissolved oxygen, pH), aligning with MSC-style standards for environmental monitoring.
- Reviewed, synthesized, and edited technical reports and publications for accuracy and compliance.
- Developed climate change impact models analyzing nutrient cycling, biodiversity, and carbon emissions.
- Coordinated research collaborations to integrate scientific findings to best inform policy decisions.
- Founded the first Student Government and Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee in USC Graduate Programs for the Marine and Environmental Biology department to amplify student voices, provide useful events to inform and support the student experience, and improve communication with faculty.
- Developed novel computational method to use amino acid assembly techniques in identifying viral families previously missed by nucleotide assembly techniques failing due to rapid viral genome evolution.
- Mentored two undergraduate students and two graduate students in lab techniques and safety, developing skills that served as basis for conducting their individual projects
- Authored and edited NSF GFRP grant proposal, contributed to grants for NIH, NSF, and The Simons Foundation, sharpening communication and strategic planning skills.

OCCIDENTAL COLLEGE, Los Angeles, CA

Vantuna Research Group Marine Research Assistant

08/2016 – 01/2024

- Contributed to rocky reef fisheries research through ecological surveys, species identification, and fish / invertebrate counts to monitor nearshore health and productivity.
- Conducted plankton, trawl, and sediment analyses to assess long term environmental health and fisheries ecosystem sustainability.
- Updated and maintained ecological datasets to ensure accuracy / accessibility for multi-year assessments.
- Earned AAUS Scientific Diver certification for underwater ecological and fisheries survey work.

Other Professional Experience

OCCIDENTAL COLLEGE, Los Angeles, CA

Assistant Track and Field & Strength and Conditioning Coach

01/2024 – Present

- Provide mentorship and leadership as the only female sprints coach, fostering an inclusive, productive, and goal-oriented team culture.
- Assists in the organization and coordination of team events, showcasing strong administrative and logistical skills in a fast-paced environment.

OCCIDENTAL COLLEGE, Los Angeles, CA

Athletics Executive Administrative Assistant

05/2016 – Present

- Manage project coordination, scheduling, data systems, and reporting for athletics operations.
- Develop / maintain data and web systems to streamline events, athletic teams, and resource allocation.
- Serve as a communication hub bet coordinate events, facilitate communication, and foster productive relationships for diverse stakeholders both within Athletics and in the greater university community.

ELISE MARINE DESIGNS, Windham, ME

Social Media Manager

07/2023 – 01/2024

- Curated visually appealing and brand-consistent content, including photos, videos, and graphics, resulting in an increase in customer engagement during the busy holiday season.
- Managed daily social media activities, including content creation, scheduling, posting, and community interaction.

Education

M.S. Marine and Environmental Biology, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA 2023

Thesis: Dynamics and ecology of marine during a significant warming period at a microbial observatory in Southern California and implications for future climate variation and ocean warming.

B.A. Biology (English, Neuroscience, Marine Biology minors), cum laude, Occidental College, Los Angeles, CA 2017

Athletic Achievements & Advocacy

- Member, Team USA Paralympic Track and Field (T/F35)
 - 2023 Para Pan American Games Silver (200m) and Bronze (100m) medalist (T35)
 - World Record Holder, 800m T35
 - Ongoing work with athlete-activists and media professionals to advocate for disability justice, gender equity, and inclusive storytelling in sport
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Key Publications and Presentations

- **Nolin, D.M.**, Weismann, J.L., Ignacio-Espinoza, J.C., Ahlgren, N.A., Fuhrman, J.A., "Using amino acid assembly techniques to reveal hidden viral diversity in marine viral metagenomes." *in prep*
- **Nolin, D. M.**, et al. "Free living viral community variation over depth and season in a 5-year time span from 2012-2016." *in prep*
- **Nolin, D. M.**, Needham, D., et al. "In Situ Viral Dynamics off the Coast of Southern California using Transcriptomes from Automated High-Frequency Sampling." *AGU Ocean Sciences Meeting*, 2020.
- **Nolin, D.M.**, Malki, K., Ignacio-Espinoza, J.C., Ahlgren, N.A., Fuhrman, J.A., "Free living viral community variation over depth and season in a 5 year time span from 2012-2016." *in prep*
- Weissman J.L., Dimbo E.R., Krinos A.I., Neely C., Yagües Y., **Nolin D.M.**, Hou S., Laperriere S., Caron D.A., Tully B., Alexander H. "Estimating the maximal growth rates of eukaryotic microbes from cultures and metagenomes via codon usage patterns." *bioRxiv* (2021): 2021-10.